



Chapter Bylaws

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Article I. Name and Organization

Section 1. Name.

This Chapter is officially known as the Gamma Eta Chapter, a chapter of the Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia Fraternity of America, Inc., chartered at Furman University in Greenville, South Carolina.

Section 2. Governing Documents.

The Gamma Eta Chapter is subject to all guidelines set forth in the National Constitution, Risk Management Policies, National Policies, and Gamma Eta Chapter Bylaws. The chapter is also subject to the rules and regulations of Furman University.

Article II. Membership

Section 1. Eligibility.

In addition to the requirements for eligibility as specified in the National Constitution, a candidate must participate in a musical ensemble recognized by the university at least one semester during the academic term. A candidate demonstrating a commitment to music outside of a Furman University ensemble may be exempted from this requirement by taking music lessons, being involved in a studio, or a vote of simple majority by the chapter. It is the responsibility of the candidate in question to present his commitment(s) to music outside of a Furman University ensemble as stipulated above to the brotherhood at the beginning of each applicable term.

Section 2. Probationary Membership.

The brotherhood is responsible for initiating a list of prospective members by introducing names from the floor at a regular business meeting. Additions to the list may continue to be submitted from the floor until voting on all prospective members is complete. The candidates will be openly discussed. A candidate is eligible for probationary membership by the affirmative vote of three-fourths ($3/4$) of the active members who are present and voting. If a candidate receives one-half ($1/2$) majority but not three-fourths ($3/4$) majority vote on the first round of voting, he is eligible for a second and decisive round of free discussion and voting in which he must receive a three-fourths ($3/4$) majority in order to be eligible for probationary membership. This decision will be final for the duration of the academic school year.

The Fraternity Education Officer (FEO) is to, in writing, notify all candidates of their bid status no more than seven (7) days after the fraternity vote. Upon acceptance of an invitation to membership, candidates are known as probationary members, and are to be initiated according to the official ritual. During the probationary period, the FEO must call no less than two voting checkpoints, the first no later than the third week following pinning and the second no later than the sixth week following pinning, in which to consider a probationary member's status. Each probationary member must pass each checkpoint with a three-fourths ($3/4$) majority vote; if the vote is not approved, the probationary member must meet with the Executive Committee. Requirements for good standing will then be set by the Executive Committee on a case by case basis; these must be accomplished by the next checkpoint. If the probationary member does not fulfill the requirements to the full approval of the brotherhood, he may not retain his probationary membership status.

There may be two (2) probationary member classes: one (1) during Fall semester, and one (1) during Spring semester.

Section 3. Collegiate Membership.

A candidate is eligible for collegiate membership by the affirmative vote of three-fourths (3/4) of the active members who are present and in good standing. All votes are cast by secret ballot. If a candidate receives one-half (1/2) majority but not three-fourths (3/4) majority vote on the first round of voting, he is eligible for a second and decisive round of free discussion and voting in which he must receive a number of affirmative votes equaling at least three-fourths (3/4) of members who are present and in good standing.

Section 4. Alumni Membership

A collegiate member in good standing is transferred to alumni membership when he terminates his academic affiliation with Furman University (see National-Constitution and Bylaws for more information). A collegiate member may transfer to alumni membership after having paid per capita taxes and chapter dues for future semesters only with Faculty Advisor (FA) and Province Governor (PG) approval after the member submits a formal written request to his FA, PG, and a formal notice to the chapter. The only chapter sponsored events alumni members are allowed to attend are rituals and any Gamma Eta weekly chapter meetings, but they will not be able to have any standing at those meetings.

Section 5. Disaffiliation from the Chapter.

A brother who no longer wishes to be a member of the chapter may decide to disaffiliate. Written notification of this decision must be given to the chapter president. The member seeking disaffiliation is expected to return his pin, jersey, and any other items he received through membership in the fraternity. The member seeking disaffiliation will be expelled from the chapter and the National Fraternity in accordance with Title I Article I Section 7 of the National Bylaws

Article III. Officers and Positions

Section 1. Officers.

This chapter annually elects brothers to the offices of President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Historian, Warden, Alumni Relations Officer, and Fraternity Education Officer. Multiple brothers may not jointly hold an office unless otherwise specified by the National Bylaws. The chapter triennially elects at least one Faculty Advisor.

Section 2. Positions.

This chapter annually elects brothers to the positions of Music Director, Webmaster, Publicity Chairman, Social Chairman, Projects Chairman, and Philanthropy Chairman. This chapter elects only one brother to each office. Multiple brothers may not jointly hold a position.

Section 3. Nomination.

At least 15 days prior to the scheduled chapter election, and no later than March 15, the chapter president appoints a nominating committee which should include at least the president, one other officer, and one member of each academic class. Brothers that wish to be slated cannot serve on the Nominating Committee. On or before election day and no later than April 1, the nominating committee reports its choice of one man for each office to be filled. Additional nominations may be made from the floor by members in good standing until voting for the office or position in question is complete.

Section 4. Election and Installation.

Election is determined after free discussion from the floor of the collegiate members followed by a simple majority vote of brothers in good standing who are present. Each man serves a term of one (1) year or until his successor has been installed. There are no restrictions on the number of terms a brother may serve in a particular office. Should a vacancy occur in any office, it may be filled by a majority vote at any meeting. The brother initially vacated may not be reinstated into the position for the remainder of the academic year.

Section 5. Duties of Officers.

President.

The President shall preside at chapter meetings, shall guide the conduct of the affairs of the chapter, and shall perform such other duties as the chapter may specify. He shall act for the chapter in all matters affecting the national organization and approve all correspondence between the chapter and the national officers. With the Secretary, he shall prepare the chapter report twice each year. He shall see that each chapter report, together with the required per capita tax and convocation tax payments, is submitted to the national headquarters at the proper time. In all voting situations, the President's vote shall be reserved to decide a tie. The President may request a report from another officer regarding the fulfillment of officer duties at any time. The President shall have the authority to delegate all duties not specified by the Chapter Bylaws.

Vice President.

The Vice President, in the absence or incapacity of the President, shall perform the duties of the president, and shall perform such other duties as the chapter may specify. The Vice President shall also be responsible for maintaining the Chapter Bylaws. The Vice President shall be responsible for the adherence to all governing documents during all fraternity meetings and events. The Vice President shall serve ex officio on every committee and shall ensure that committees are meeting as needed and accomplishing tasks as directed by the chapter and the President. He shall assign membership to the Social/ Publicity, Projects/Philanthropy, Fraternity Education, and Alumni Relations committees. He shall have the authority to call meetings of any of these committees at his discretion. The Vice President shall be the official correspondence for the sweetheart for all events that she is permitted to attend. It shall be the responsibility of the Vice President to ensure business meetings adhere to Robert's Rules of Order. The offices of Vice President and Fraternity Education Officer may be held by the same person.

Secretary.

The Secretary, through the chapter President, shall keep the national staff accurately informed of the status of all collegiate members, and of the chapter elections, programs, and all other official functions. On a weekly basis, he shall keep and publicize to the brotherhood the minutes of chapter meetings, keep an accurate list of members of the chapter, and perform such other duties as the chapter may specify. The minutes shall be publicized no more than twenty-four (24) hours after the event and must contain all relevant information. He shall be responsible for obtaining attendance records of committee meetings from their respective chairs immediately following each meeting. The Secretary shall maintain a running attendance of all brotherhood activities, including song rehearsal, chapter meetings, all probationary member events, and committee meetings, respectively to be publicized to the chapter. Attendance shall be updated immediately following each event. The offices of Secretary and Treasurer may be held by the same person.

Treasurer.

The Treasurer shall receive and disburse all chapter funds and shall be personally responsible for all fraternity funds coming into his possession; he shall, twice in each school year, submit to the chapter President a complete statement of the chapter finances, and shall at all times render such information about chapter finances as shall be requested by the chapter

President or the national staff. He shall submit complete financial statements to the faculty advisor. He shall collect and, through the chapter President, remit to the National Treasurer all such taxes and dues as the National Treasurer may lawfully demand. He shall deposit, in an approved bank or with the appropriate school officer, the funds of the chapter, and shall pay, or cause to be paid, by check all claims against the chapter upon the approval of the Chapter Executive Committee. He shall deposit all payments of dues within seven (7) days after receiving them. He shall perform such other duties as the chapter may specify. The offices of Treasurer and Secretary may be held by the same person.

Fraternity Education Officer.

The Fraternity Education Officer (FEO) shall have primary responsibility for the development of fraternity education programs. These are to include programs for chapter members designed to advance the Object of the fraternity, as well as a probationary membership program designed to develop responsible and mature chapter members through constructive and cooperative activities. The FEO shall be responsible for all information sessions regarding probationary membership. The FEO shall be responsible for delivering formal membership invitations to men elected to collegiate membership and filing initiation reports with the national headquarters. The FEO may appoint, by a majority vote of the chapter of those in good standing, an Assistant FEO whose duties shall be specified by the FEO. The FEO shall work with the Executive Committee to plan the probationary membership events and will inform the brotherhood of each event. The offices of Fraternity Education Officer and Vice President may be held by the same person.

Alumni Relations Officer.

The Alumni Relations Officer (ARO) shall compile and keep an accurate list of names and contact information of all former members of the chapter and of other alumni Sinfonians in the area. He shall notify the National Headquarters of any changes in contact information, as well as any chapters or associations in other localities of his own chapter's alumni moving into their geographic areas. He shall be responsible for the creation and distribution of an annual alumni newsletter. He shall assist in the coordination of the chapter's alumni functions and shall regularly inform and invite local and chapter alumni to chapter events. He shall act as a liaison between the chapter and any associations in his locality. He shall perform such other local duties as his collegiate chapter may designate but shall hold no other chapter office. He shall be responsible for the organization of the fraternity composite photograph.

Warden.

The Warden shall guard the door at all chapter meetings and manage the circulation of Initiation Ritual scripts. He shall be the official custodian of the ballot box and all of the Initiation Ritual equipment and perform other such duties as the chapter may specify including the maintenance and upkeep of the fraternity closet. He is in charge of approving use of the sound system for non-fraternity events. He is also responsible for discipline at all fraternity gatherings.

Historian.

Through the President, the Historian of the chapter shall assist in preparing all National Publications, by making prompt and full reports of all local news and other facts, which the fraternity may request, and perform such other duties as the chapter may specify. He shall keep complete archives of the chapter's activities. The Historian shall assist the Alumni Relations Officer in compiling photos for the alumni newsletter, senior slideshow, and other publications or media.

Faculty Advisor.

The Faculty Advisor shall act in an advisory capacity, be liaison officer between the chapter and the local college authorities and be kept informed of all Chapter activities. He may hold active membership in the chapter pursuant to Article II, Section Six, of the National Constitution, in which case he shall enjoy all privileges and assume all obligations, including financial obligations of active membership. Should he retain or elect alumni status, he shall have no ex officio vote, nor shall

he be responsible for per capita tax or local dues. The Faculty Advisor certifies the content of all chapter reports and results of the national examination with his signature. The Chapter may elect more than one advisor.

Section 6. Duties of Elected Positions.

Music Director.

The Music Director shall be responsible for all musical performances by the chapter, including the American Music Concert, and shall be the custodian of all sheet music and files. The American Music Concert is defined as a performance devoted to music composed by Americans and may include musical students not in the fraternity. The Music Director is also responsible for notifying the Brotherhood of upcoming musical events. The Music Director shall be responsible for ensuring that the brotherhood performs at least one chapter Mills Music Mission per academic semester. The performance shall be organized no less than one (1) month in advance. The Music Director shall work with the President to schedule and organize each Mills Music Mission. In collaboration with the Warden, the Music Director is expected to schedule rehearsals for the chapter's annual Ritual. The Music Director will appoint a brother or brothers responsible for the transportation and assembly of the chapter sound system. The sound system is only allowed to be used at fraternity events and/or monitored by brothers after receiving approval from the Warden. The Music Director may appoint, by a majority vote of the chapter, an Assistant Music Director whose duties shall be specified by the Music Director.

Webmaster.

The webmaster shall have administrative control of the chapter's social and organizational media. He is responsible for the upkeep of the chapter's webpage and other websites associated with the chapter, including but not limited to mySinfonia, GINSystem, Google Drive, and SyncDin. He is also responsible for the registration of new members.

Publicity Chairman.

The Publicity Chairman shall be responsible for publicizing fraternity functions at least ten days in advance by method of both paper and electronic flyers, chalking in the Trone Student Center, and any other means as designated by the event officer. He shall be responsible for maintaining the bulletin board and must update it accordingly before the first chapter of each semester. He is responsible for the upkeep of the chapter's social media. He may create social media accounts with approval from the chapter. The Publicity Chairman shall be responsible for maintaining the attendance records for all ushered events. The Publicity Chairman shall work with the Projects Chairman to undertake any other projects that may boost the public image of the fraternity.

Social Chairman.

The Social Chairman shall be responsible for planning and implementing all rush events, homecoming, the chapter's formal, and other social functions designated by the chapter. He is also responsible for ordering class jerseys within seven days of the Ritual, the jersey for the new sweetheart no later than seven days after she is elected, and other event t-shirts when necessary.

Projects Chairman.

The Projects Chairman, along with the Philanthropy Chairman, shall be responsible for organizing projects that assist in the development of a greater community, both musical and otherwise. The Projects Chairman shall also coordinate all aspects of the annual Talent Showcase, held in conjunction with Furman Parents' Programs on Family Weekend of every year. He shall hold a fundraiser each academic semester, including the Talent Showcase. The Projects Chairman shall fundraise an amount of money to be determined by the yearly budget.

Philanthropy Chairman.

The Philanthropy Chairman shall be responsible for organizing all humanities/community service events during the academic school year. The philanthropy chair is required to provide at least one (1) support and/or financial project per semester. He shall distribute funds acquired through financial projects, with agreement from the chapter, at his discretion. The Philanthropy Chairman shall decide if an event created is mandatory for the chapter. The Philanthropy Chairman is not responsible for the organization and scheduling of the fraternity's Mills Music Missions but may work with the Music Director in organizing musical events.

Section 7. Sweetheart.

The Gamma Eta chapter of Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia may elect a rising senior female as chapter sweetheart for the term of one academic year. Only one individual may hold this position at any given time. The sweetheart should represent the ideals of Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia. The title of "sweetheart" is an honor and does not bestow any form of membership in Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia upon the recipient. While the sweetheart is not permitted to attend any brother or probationary-member exclusive events such as chapter meetings, committee meetings, or any events leading or pertaining to Initiation Ritual, she is encouraged to attend all social, rush, fundraising, and philanthropy events.

Article IV. Committees

Section 1. Description.

The standing committees of this chapter shall be the Executive, Social/Publicity, Projects/Philanthropy, Fraternity Education, Alumni Relations, Audit, Nominating and Bylaw Review Committees. The Vice President shall assign membership to the Social/Publicity, Projects/Philanthropy, Fraternity Education, and Alumni Relations committees. The Vice President shall have the authority to call meetings of any of the aforementioned committees at his discretion. Committee membership shall be mandatory of each brother per term excluding the special cases of foreign study and student teaching. Appointments shall be made before the first business meeting of the fall term and remain throughout the academic year. The Nominating Committee and Bylaw Review Committee must meet at least once per academic year. Each other committee must meet at least once per semester. Minutes and attendance of each committee will be taken by the Vice President. These minutes, excluding those taken by the executive committee, will be published to the chapter no more than twenty-four (24) hours following the meeting. Each respective committee head will be fined \$15 if they do not hold their required meeting.

Section 2. Executive Committee.

The Executive Committee, under the chairmanship of the President of the chapter, shall be composed of the Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, FEO, Alumni Relations Officer, and Warden. This committee shall act in an advisory capacity to the President and shall review proposals brought up for consideration to the chapter and shall report those proposals to the chapter. At the end of every fall semester, the Executive Committee will review each officer and determine if they adequately performed their responsibilities, and take action if necessary. The Executive Committee will meet at the discretion of the chairman.

Section 3. Social/Publicity Committee.

The Social Chairman and Publicity Chairman shall co-head the Social Publicity committee, which shall also include the FEO, Treasurer, Alumni Relations Officer, and Webmaster. This committee shall be responsible for all social and rush

activities of the chapter. In addition, this committee shall be responsible for assisting the Publicity Chairman in publicizing events.

Section 4. Projects/Philanthropy Committee.

The Projects and Philanthropy Chairmen shall co-head the Projects/Philanthropy Committee, which shall be responsible for the planning and executing of any special projects, and which will include the Treasurer, Webmaster, and the Music Director. The agenda of a particular meeting will determine the presiding officer. Projects include, but are not limited to, any music outreach programs of the chapter and other philanthropies affiliated with and approved by the chapter.

Section 5. Fraternity Education Committee.

The Fraternity Education Committee will be headed by the FEO and shall include the President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Social Chairman. The committee shall be responsible for implementing and overseeing the fraternity education program.

Section 6. Alumni Relations Committee.

The Alumni Relations Committee shall be headed by the Alumni Relations Officer and shall include the Treasurer, the Social Chairman, the Secretary. The committee shall coordinate functions involving alumni and shall manage the records and contact information of alumni.

Section 7. Audit Committee.

The Audit Committee, under the chairmanship of the President of the chapter, shall be composed of three brothers. While the Audit Committee should not include the Treasurer, the Treasurer should make himself available to answer any questions from the Audit Committee. The Audit Committee is charged with oversight of financial reporting and disclosure for the annual chapter reports.

Section 8. Nominating Committee.

The Nominating Committee, under the chairmanship of the President of the chapter, shall be composed of the President, one officer, and one brother from each academic year, unless a listed position's current holder is up for nomination as per Article Three (3), Section Three (3), in which case they may not serve upon the Nominating Committee. The Nominating Committee will be required to meet annually after the installation of new Brothers in the spring term, in accordance with Article Three (3), Section Three (3).

Section 9. Bylaw Review Committee.

The Bylaw Review Committee, under the chairmanship of the Vice President of the chapter, shall be composed of all members of the executive committee from both the past and upcoming years and other members appointed by the committee chair. The committee shall be responsible for reviewing and revising, if necessary, all chapter bylaws.

Section 10. Special Committees.

Special Committees may be appointed by the President or Vice President at their discretion.

Article V. Meetings.

Section 1. Regular Meetings.

Regular meetings shall be held once a week during the school year, preferably at a regular time and place each week. The President shall be responsible for notifying the chapter of weekly song rehearsals and chapter meetings at least 24 hours in advance.

Section 2. Special Meetings.

The President shall reserve the right to call a special meeting with prior notice of no less than two (2) days being given to each member preceding a proposed special meeting, which shall be defined as any meeting that falls outside of the regular meeting schedule.

Section 3. Committee Meetings.

Committee Chairs shall schedule meetings as necessary but no less than once a semester to coordinate the fulfillment of their committee's responsibilities.

Section 4. Song Rehearsals.

Song rehearsals shall be announced at the chapter meeting preceding the rehearsal date. Song rehearsals may take place before or after a meeting, or at any other scheduled time.

Article VI. Attendance.

Section 1. Brotherhood Events.

The following events will be considered Brotherhood Events: Formal Initiation, Business Meetings, Mills Music Missions, Information Sessions, Rush Events, Special Meetings, and Probationary Member Activities. These events are required for all brothers to attend.

Section 2. Musical Events.

The following events will be considered Musical Events: Phi Mu Alpha sponsored concerts, song rehearsals, and formal serenades. These events are required for all brothers to attend.

Section 3. Ushering.

The Brotherhood is required to assist the Music Department by ushering for concerts and recitals. The number of ushering credits required from each brother shall be determined by the Publicity Chairman at the beginning of each academic term. Failure to meet requirements determined by the Publicity Chairman will result in an unexcused absence.

Section 4. Province Events.

The Brotherhood is required to attend the annual Province Workshop and all National Events that are presented by the Province. The Brotherhood is encouraged to attend all other Province events. The validity of an absence from a Province event must be approved by the President.

Section 5. Social Events.

The Brotherhood, via the Social Chairman, is encouraged to host and be present at social events. The Social Chairman shall decide if an event created is mandatory for the chapter. All brothers on Chapter Probation are prohibited from attending chapter-funded social events.

Section 6. Excuses.

Attendance excuses must be presented to the Secretary, the President, and the presiding officer for the event no less than twenty-four (24) hours in advance except in case of illness or emergency. Legitimacy of the excuses presented will be determined by the presiding officer(s). If an unexcused absence is given, a brother may appeal the decision to the Executive Committee using the Attendance Appeal Form. Attendance Appeal Forms must be sent to the Secretary no later than seventy-two (72) hours after the unexcused absence is given. The Secretary shall present such an appeal at the next Executive Committee meeting.

Section 7. Notification of Events.

Before any event can be made required, it must be announced to the brotherhood no less than 48 hours for chapter and song rehearsal and two weeks in advance for any other events. Any exceptions can be brought to the Executive Committee for approval. If the notification deadline is not met, then a brother may not make an event required.

Section 8. Fines.

Fines will be incurred through an unexcused absence or tardy to any required event. The fine amount will be defined by Article IX Section 7. If a fine is given, a brother may appeal the decision to the Executive Committee using the Fine Appeal Form. Fine Appeal Forms must be sent to the Treasurer no later than 72 hours after the fine is given. The Treasurer shall present such an appeal at the next Executive Committee meeting.

Article VII. Voting

Section 1. General Voting Procedure.

Unless otherwise specified, voting shall be by a general vote, i.e. by upraised hand, and the outcome will be determined by a simple majority of those present and in good standing. In the event of a tie, the President shall cast the deciding vote.

Section 2. Secret Ballot.

A secret ballot vote may be requested by any brother for any vote. In all situations, this request will be honored.

Section 3. Chapter Elections.

During chapter officer and position elections, voting shall be done by using the ranking system. The ranking system shall be defined as listing all candidates for a given office in the order of preference, the first candidate listing being the voter's top choice. Each candidate shall receive a point value based on their ranking on the list, with the last candidate receiving (0) zero points and each consecutive higher-ranking candidate receiving one (1) additional point thereafter. The candidate with the highest point total shall be elected to the given office. In the event of a tie, the President reserves the right to cast the deciding vote.

Article VIII. Discipline

Section 1. Absences.

Absences shall be defined as missing a required event as stipulated in Article VI. Each member is allowed two (2) unexcused absences per semester. Two (2) unexcused tardies equals one (1) unexcused absence. A tardy constitutes arriving late or leaving early from a required event without an excuse and shall be assessed at the discretion of the presiding officer. Only one (1) unexcused absence will be given for missing both a song rehearsal and meeting if held on the same night. If a member misses a song rehearsal but is present for the subsequent meeting and does not have a legitimate excuse, then the member is given an unexcused tardy. After two (2) unexcused absences a member may be formally suspended. Should a member incur an unexcused absence from a Formal Initiation or a concert, or three (3) unexcused absences, National Suspension shall be automatic. An officer will receive an absence if the Executive Committee believes they are not fulfilling their responsibilities. An example of this would be the Music Director receiving an absence for not coordinating an American Music Concert. If the officer in question is a part of the Executive Committee, the rest of the Executive Committee will make the decision.

Section 2. Formal Reprimand.

Formal Reprimand shall be defined as a brother who is not upholding the standards or ideals of the fraternity will receive a notice from the President. The brother will come before the Executive Committee to discuss their responsibilities as a brother and to be notified that the next step is Chapter Probation. An officer will not yet be removed from their position at this stage.

Section 3. Chapter Probation.

Chapter Probation shall be defined as loss of brotherhood privileges including but not limited to voting and participation in discussion. If an officer is suspended, the office is vacated. At each meeting the Secretary shall read a list of all brothers on Chapter Probation. A brother may be suspended for the following reasons: an evident lack of interest in activities, responsibilities, or commitments required of the brotherhood, a disregard for chapter welfare, minor behavioral issues or conduct deemed harmful to the chapter as defined by the national bylaws, failure to meet the minimum academic performance standards for successful continuation as a student in good standing as defined by the sheltering institution, excessive unexcused absences, or other reasonable causes. The Executive Committee shall meet to determine the length of the suspension and the conditions that must be met for the brother to return to good standing. When the brother has completed the term of suspension, the Executive Committee shall recommend to the brotherhood at a general meeting to reinstate the suspended brother, continue Chapter Probation, or place the brother on National Suspension. The brotherhood will then hold votes in the following order: 1) To reinstate the suspended brother; 2) To place the brother on National Suspension. If neither vote gets two-thirds majority then the brother's Chapter Probation is continued for length determined by the Executive Committee. Each vote shall be conducted by secret ballot and requires a two-thirds (2/3) majority of all brothers present and voting.

Section 4. Financial Suspension.

Financial Suspension shall be defined as loss of brotherhood privileges including but not limited to voting and participation in discussion. A brother may be Financially Suspended for failure to pay dues. If a brother has not paid the amount owed to the brotherhood by the following chapter report, he will be automatically placed on National Suspension. Brothers who are placed on Financial Suspension will be immediately reinstated upon their payment of the amount owed to the brotherhood.

Section 5. National Suspension.

National Suspension shall be defined as loss of brotherhood privileges including but not limited to voting and the attendance of fraternity-sponsored social events. If an officer is suspended, the office is vacated. While a chapter may choose to allow a suspended member to participate in meetings and activities, he has no voting rights, cannot be elected to any office, cannot act as a big brother or mentor, is prohibited from purchasing fraternal merchandise, and is prohibited from wearing or otherwise displaying the Greek letters "ΦMA" or the Fraternity's Coat-of-Arms. At each meeting the secretary shall read a list of all brothers on National Suspension. A member may be suspended in cases more extreme than in Chapter Probation for the following reasons: an evident lack of interest in activities, responsibilities, or commitments required of the brotherhood, a disregard for chapter welfare, minor behavioral issues or conduct deemed harmful to the chapter as defined by the national bylaws, failure to meet the minimum academic performance standards for successful continuation as a student in good standing as defined by the sheltering institution, excessive unexcused absences, or other reasonable causes. The arrival to and disruption of a rush, probationary member, or ceremonial event while under the influence of any alcohol or drug or use of any alcohol or drug during a rush, probationary member, or ceremonial event will result in immediate placement on National Suspension.

A member may be brought forth for National Suspension by any other active brother. The suspension vote shall be held at the next meeting and he shall be notified in writing by the President of the motion no less than seventy-two (72) hours prior to the next meeting. The notification shall contain the reason for the proposed suspension, his right to an appeal to the Executive Council, and times and places for proposed interviews with the Executive Council and Faculty Advisor. Should the member request a meeting with the Executive Council before the scheduled voting date, there shall be no vote on the motion until the meeting has been held. The brother in question has a limit of one (1) week to have the executive council meeting; otherwise, the vote may occur.

After written notification has been sent to the accused member, the vote shall be taken at the next meeting attended by the accused member. If the accused member incurs an unexcused absence after receiving written notification, the vote shall be held at the next meeting. Immediately prior to voting, there shall be two (2) periods of discussion. The first period shall be between the accused member and the brotherhood; the second shall be with the accused member removed from the meeting. The motion for suspension must pass by a three-fourths (3/4) majority of all those present and voting. If the brother is currently on Chapter Probation, then the motion for National Suspension must pass by a two-thirds majority of all those present and voting. The accused member may not vote. Voting shall be done by secret ballot.

When a member is suspended for reasons other than nonpayment of dues, the Executive Committee shall meet to determine the length of the suspension and the conditions that must be met for the brother to return to good standing. When the brother has completed the term of suspension, the Executive Committee shall recommend to the brotherhood at a general meeting to reinstate the suspended brother, continue suspension, or expel the suspended brother. The brotherhood will then hold votes in the following order: 1) To reinstate the suspended brother; 2) To expel the suspended brother. If neither vote gets two-thirds majority then the brother's National Suspension is continued for length determined by the Executive Committee. Each vote shall be conducted by secret ballot and requires a two-thirds (2/3) majority of all brothers present and voting.

Brothers who are placed on formal suspension for nonpayment of dues will be immediately reinstated upon their payment of the amount owed to the brotherhood. If the brother whom is placed on National Suspension holds an office, his office shall be vacated immediately. After reinstatement, the brother may not reclaim his vacated office, nor may he be permitted to fill another office or position within the same term.

Section 6. Expulsion.

The brotherhood may vote, with due reason, to expel a brother from the fraternity. Prior to the expulsion vote, said brother shall receive written notification of the expulsion vote from the President at least one (1) week in advance of the motion. The written notification shall contain the reason for expulsion and the member's right of appeal to the National Executive Committee, should the proposed expulsion come to pass. Immediately prior to voting, there shall be two (2) periods of discussion. The first period shall be between the accused member and the brotherhood; the second shall be with the accused member removed from the meeting. The accused member may not vote. Voting shall be done by secret ballot. The expulsion vote must pass by a three-fourths ($3/4$) majority of all members present and in good standing. If the brother is currently on National Suspension, then the motion for expulsion must pass by a two-thirds majority of all those present and voting. If a suspended member is not reinstated before the date of his graduation or departure from the sheltering institution, he is automatically expelled from the Fraternity.

Article IX. Finances

Section 1. Dues.

The dues for each collegiate member shall be set by the Treasurer with the proposed budget for the following year. Brothers on Study Away are required to pay national taxes unless holding a national office, in which case he will be required to pay chapter and national dues. Alumni Members are not subject to payment of dues. All Honorary Member dues shall be paid by the chapter.

Section 2. Probationary Member Dues.

Probationary Members are required to pay the National initiation dues to the Treasurer, who will be responsible for payment to the National Office. National fees must be paid in full before a man may be initiated into the fraternity. The remaining amount shall be paid no later than at the first chapter in which the probationary member is a brother.

Section 3. Nonpayment of Dues.

It is the obligation of each member to make arrangements with the Treasurer for payment of dues. Dues may be paid in full at the beginning of each school year, or in installments previously set at the discretion of the Treasurer, payable by a date set by the Treasurer. Dues must be paid to the Treasurer in person and prior to the day of fraternity-sponsored events unless specific arrangements have been made with the Treasurer. If dues are not paid on time and no arrangements have been made with the treasurer, the brother is formally suspended. If a brother has not paid their per capita tax by the submission of the Chapter Report, they shall incur an additional late fee set by National Standards. Suspension automatically ends upon payment of dues or upon making proper arrangements with the treasurer given specific dates as to when the dues will be paid. In addition to dues, if a deadline for payment is specified for any social or other event and the brother has not paid, said brother shall be placed on Chapter Probation until payment is made.

Section 4. Financial Expulsion.

Per Gamma Eta's payment plan, if the complete payment of dues is not met 30 days after the end of each academic semester, the member will be immediately placed on financial expulsion. A member on financial expulsion will be considered expelled. The payment of dues will result in immediate reinstatement of membership.

Section 5. Budget.

Before the last meeting of the academic year, a budget shall be passed for the following fiscal year, which extends from August through July. The budget must pass by an affirmative vote of three-fourths (3/4) of the collegiate members present and in good standing. The budget must be presented at two successive meetings and must be approved after the second reading.

Section 6. Financial Policy.

The Treasurer is given the power to authorize routine expenditures allowed in the budget. However, no officer, committee, or member of this chapter shall obligate the chapter financially without the consent of the chapter on any special expense. There shall be no expenditures without the approval of the chapter. Any unauthorized expenditure without proper consent is not guaranteed to be paid. Furthermore, any contract to be signed by any member therefore binding the fraternity, financially or otherwise, must come before, be read, and approved by the chapter. Any debts incurred on the chapter by a single brother are the responsibility of said brother, not the chapter.

Section 7. Fines.

Fines will be incurred through an unexcused absence or tardy to any required event. The fine amount will be \$5 for an unexcused tardy and \$10 for an unexcused absence. The fine amount will be added to a brother's dues and must be paid by the time that the final payment of dues for that term are due. If a fine is given, a brother may appeal the decision to the Executive Committee using the Attendance Appeal Form. Attendance Appeal Forms must be sent to the Secretary no later than 72 hours after the fine is given. The Secretary shall present such an appeal at the next Executive Committee meeting.

Section 8. Reimbursements.

Officers and Chairs who require funds to make budgeted fraternity purchases should request a check from the Treasurer no less than three days in advance. Any unauthorized purchases, including overspending of budget lines, are not guaranteed to be paid. Reimbursements can be made for any approved fraternity expenditures. If transportation is required to a fraternity-sponsored event, any driver carpooling three or more brothers may request gas reimbursement. The Treasurer and presiding officer will decide if gas reimbursement is appropriate, and the rate will reflect the most current IRS Charity Mileage Rates. No reimbursement will be paid for such expenditures without an appropriate proof of purchases delivered to the Treasurer. The treasurer will remind the chapter of said rate 48 hours before departure.

Section 9. Annual Chapter Audit.

Each year, the audit committee will conduct a Chapter Audit. The purpose of this audit will be to check arithmetic and to verify that proper financial records have been kept. Records that will be needed are the chapter checkbook, journal, cash box, ledger, receipt book, and bank statements for the year. In addition, the current files of bills issued, bills paid, statements or receipts from the National Headquarters, and savings account statements should be available.

Article X. Special Observances

Section 1. Historical Days.

This chapter shall observe, with appropriate programs, three (3) historical days of the fraternity: Founders' Day, October 6; and Chapter Days, January 10 and December 27.

Section 2. Concerts.

The chapter shall present an American Music Concert each year and may also present other concerts as it sees fit. The Music Director may not schedule any other performances without consent of the simple majority of the chapter.

Article XI. Awards

Section 1. Orpheus Award.

This chapter may present each year an award entitled the Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia, Gamma Eta Chapter, Orpheus Award. This award shall be given to any member of the Furman University community whom the chapter feels has done the most in furthering the purposes of our fraternity specifically the advancement of music in America. The award is given to the nominee receiving a majority of the votes of the members present and in good standing. This award may not be awarded to the same individual more than once within a four-year time period.

Section 2. Thomas T. Goldsmith Award.

The Thomas T. Goldsmith Award shall be given to the rising senior not pursuing a Bachelor of Music degree, in the judgment of the chapter, has done the most toward furthering the cause of music while at Furman University. The recipient may be a male or female who has shown a high degree of participation and commitment to the music department, while not being a member of Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia. The recipient may be a candidate for a Bachelor of Art degree in Music. Factors that will be considered include ensemble participation, performance on recitals, continued commitment to lessons, participation in music-related organizations, and leadership positions within music ensembles or organizations. Grade point average will not be a consideration for this award. Additional nominations may be taken from the floor at the meeting of the chapter. The nominees shall be voted on by the brotherhood, with the recipient being chosen by a simple majority of the brothers present and in good standing. The amount of the monetary award shall be determined by the brotherhood, and the presentation of the award shall be made at the Spring Honors Recital sponsored by the Furman University Music Department.

Section 3. Keith Lockhart Award.

The Keith Lockhart Award shall be given to the rising senior music major who, in the judgment of the chapter, has done the most toward furthering the cause of music while at Furman University. The recipient may be a male or female pursuing a Bachelor of Music degree, who has shown a high degree of participation and commitment to the music department, while not being a member of Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia. Factors that will be considered include ensemble participation, performance on recitals, continued commitment to lessons, participation in music-related organizations, and leadership positions within music ensembles or organizations. Grade point average will not be a consideration for this award. Recommendations for recipients may be received from each full-time music faculty member. Additional nominations may be taken from the floor at the meeting of the chapter. The nominees shall be voted on by the brotherhood, with the recipient being chosen by a simple majority of the brothers present and in good standing. The amount of the monetary

award shall be determined by the brotherhood, and the presentation of the award shall be made at the Spring Honors Recital sponsored by the Furman University Music Department.

Article XII. Amendments

Section 1. Regulations for Amendments.

These chapter bylaws may be amended at any business meeting by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of members present and in good standing, provided the proposed change does not violate the governing documents. All amendments to the chapter bylaws shall be read, discussed, and voted upon after discussion.

Section 2. Review of Chapter Bylaws.

These chapter bylaws shall be reviewed annually by the Bylaw Review Committee.

Section 3. COVID Clause

In the event that Furman sends students home early for an extended period of time, an individual may present his case to the executive committee of whether or not a requirement should be waived.